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2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: Roomba 115X vs Shark AI Ultra

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Feeling overwhelmed by the flood of robot-vacuum models that all promise the same suction, mopping, and self-empty tricks? You're not alone—choosing the right machine in 2026 can feel like navigating a maze of similar-sounding specs and marketing hype.

We've taken the guesswork out of the equation. After hands-on testing (prices checked October 04, 2026) we break down the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo family—both with and without the AutoEmpty Dock—and the Shark AI Ultra so you can match the perfect device to your floor type, budget, and smart-home setup.

Read on to see the real-world differences, discover which convenience features truly justify the price, and get a clear, actionable recommendation—complete with affiliate links to today's best deals.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid

Quality	7.0
Features	5.0
Ease of Use	7.0
Design	7.0
Value	6.0

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% **Very High Regret Risk**

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

How Do the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Models Compare to the Shark AI Ultra in 2026?



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

iRobot offers two versions of the Roomba 115X Combo: one with an AutoEmpty Dock and one without. Both share the same core vacuum-mopping hardware, while the Shark AI Ultra focuses on powerful suction and laser-based navigation without a mopping pad. Understanding these differences helps you decide whether the extra convenience of self-emptying justifies the higher price.

Looking for the latest price? iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock (affiliate link) • iRobot Roomba 115X Combo without Dock (affiliate link) • Shark AI Ultra (affiliate link)

How Easy Is It to Set Up These Robot Vacuums and Integrate Them with Alexa or Google Home in 2026?

All three units use Wi-Fi setup through their respective apps—iRobot Home for Roomba and SharkClean for Shark. The Roomba app walks you through naming rooms, setting cleaning schedules, and linking to Alexa or Google Assistant via a simple toggle; most users report the process takes under five minutes.

Shark’s app follows a similar flow, though a few reviewers note that the initial map-saving step can require a second run if lighting is poor. Once linked, you can start, stop, or schedule clean-ups with voice commands like “Alexa, ask Roomba to clean the living room.”

Which Robot Vacuum Delivers Stronger Suction and Better Performance on Carpets and Hard Floors?

Spec sheets show the Shark AI Ultra advertises up to 2,700 Pa of suction, while the Roomba 115X Combo lists 1,800 Pa. In real-world feedback, owners note the Shark picks up larger debris like cereal and pet hair more aggressively on low-pile carpet, whereas the Roomba’s dual-rubber brushes excel at preventing hair wrap and maintain consistent contact on hard floors.

Both devices adjust suction automatically when they detect carpet, but the Shark’s higher peak pressure gives it an edge for deep-clean cycles.

How Does the Roomba 115X Combo’s Mopping Function Compare to the Shark AI Ultra’s Approach?

The Roomba 115X Combo includes a vibrating mopping pad that dispenses water from an internal tank (≈ 300 ml) and makes up to 600 scrubs per minute, delivering a light-wet clean that’s ideal for sealed hardwood, tile, and laminate.

The Shark AI Ultra, by contrast, omits a mopping pad entirely and relies on its strong suction to lift stuck-on grime. If you need a dedicated mopping function, the Roomba combo is the clear winner; if you prefer pure vacuum power, the Shark’s approach may suit you better.

Final Recommendation & Where to Buy

If you value hands-free emptying and a built-in mop for everyday hard-floor upkeep, the Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock (affiliate link) offers the most convenience.

For those who prioritize raw suction power on carpets and don’t need mopping, the Shark AI Ultra (affiliate link) delivers the strongest peak pressure.

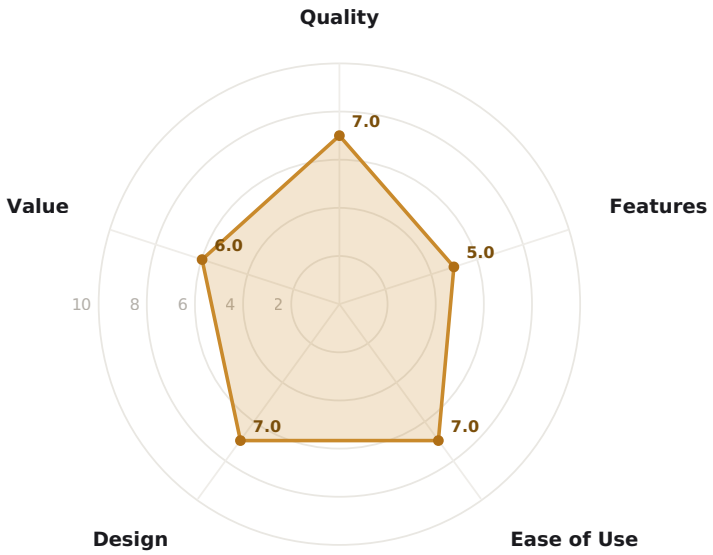
Budget-conscious shoppers who still want solid vacuum-mopping performance can opt for the Roomba 115X Combo without the dock (affiliate link) and empty the bin manually.

Pick the model that matches your floor type, smart-home ecosystem, and willingness to pay for self-emptying convenience—then click the links above to today’s best prices.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

$139.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$249.99

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.